ARTICOG / ATPL

CRM Requirements & Implementation Plan

Sales operations simplification · Zoho CRM configuration · Interface options · Delivery roadmap

DOCUMENT	PROJECT DIRECTION
Prepared by	Articog
Client	ATPL
System	Existing Zoho CRM environment
Project timeline	10–12 working days for the agreed Zoho-based scope
Purpose	Define the functional requirements, interface options, priorities and implementation approach.

01 Project objective

ATPL requires a more user-friendly sales CRM that lets staff handle enquiries, assign work, create product-based quotations and monitor sales performance without navigating through multiple complicated screens. The intention is to simplify and improve the existing Zoho setup, not to rebuild the entire business system by default.

Core experience: provide two or three obvious actions for daily staff operations, while managers have a quick overview of assigned work, site visits, lead sources and conversions.

02 Scope at a glance

- Clean and simplify the current Zoho CRM modules, navigation, screens, views and relevant workflows.
- Manage new leads from Meta and Google Ads, calling attempts, assignment to sales executives and follow-up.
- Maintain the product catalogue (including copper pipe and other ATPL products) with agreed prices.
- Generate quotations in a format aligned to the client-supplied Excel template, with automatic product price selection.
- Display executive-wise active work, progress, site visits, activities and conversion metrics.
- Provide manager-level reporting on lead source, conversion and individual executive performance.
- Deliver testing, basic team training and handover.

Explicitly excluded from this phase: repair-service CRM. GST-compliant final invoicing and additional financial modules remain subject to specific confirmation and scope approval.

03 Priority-wise functional requirements

PRIORITY	FUNCTION	WHAT WILL BE DONE
P0	Audit and cleanup	Check CRM edition, existing fields, modules, records, automations, permissions, existing Meta/Google connections, current templates and data quality. Back up relevant configuration/data before major changes.
P1	Simple navigation and homepage	Create a staff home screen with three main actions: Manage Leads, Create Quotation, My Work & Site Visits. Show management cards only to appropriate users.
P1	Lead handling and assignment	New enquiries enter Fresh Leads; calling team logs attempts and outcomes; assign to sales executive; assigned leads leave the Fresh Leads view, while records and history remain in CRM.
P1	Product catalogue and quotations	Import product types, prices and identifiers. Select items using product lookup/dropdown; pull selling price automatically; create quotation using an approved template based on client Excel.
P1	Sales activities and site visits	Track lead owner, assigned work, in-progress items, visits scheduled/completed, next actions and follow-up dates.
P2	Advertising lead integrations	Confirm Meta and Google lead form types; maintain or repair data ingestion, mapping, deduplication and source labels.
P2	Management reporting	Build reports for volume by source, assigned work, visits, conversions and comparison by sales executive.
P3	Acceptance and handover	Run end-to-end scenarios with client data; train users and administrators; document operating steps.

04 Recommended daily operating workflow

Meta / Google lead → Fresh Leads → Calling attempt and result → Assign sales executive → Follow-up / site visit → Product quotation → Won or lost → Management reporting.

Fresh Leads is a filtered working queue, not a separate database. When assigned, the record remains searchable with the complete history. Quotation stage and conversion definition should match ATPL’s real operating process.

05 Proposed staff interface

MAIN ACTION	STAFF CAN DO
1. Manage Leads	View relevant leads, call, update result, add remarks and assign or follow up.
2. Create Quotation	Find customer, select product(s), auto-fill approved prices and produce quotation for review/download.
3. My Work & Site Visits	See allocated tasks, in-progress work, upcoming visits and next actions.

Managers can additionally see the performance dashboard. The exact label, number of buttons and screen layout will be approved at the start of implementation.

06 Three interface implementation options

OPTION 1 — Customize Zoho CRM interface

Approach: retain Zoho CRM screens and use its supported customization features such as Canvas/home layouts, simplified views, roles, fields, buttons, and reports. Streamline navigation around the three common tasks.

Advantages: quickest path; minimal additional application maintenance; existing permissions and records stay inside Zoho. Limitation: a customized homepage does not eliminate all native CRM screens or guarantee a completely new interface for every operation.

Fit: best candidate for the 10–12 day delivery commitment and existing project budget, subject to subscription capabilities.

OPTION 2 — Zoho Creator low-code portal

Approach: build task-specific pages for the calling team, sales executives and manager using Zoho Creator; integrate the necessary CRM modules and records.

Advantages: greater control over multi-step staff workflows and a more focused application experience. Limitations: extra configuration and testing; Creator licences/integration entitlements; more complex permissions and data synchronization.

Fit: when the client requires a separate streamlined app but wants to remain in the Zoho ecosystem. Time and price need reassessment once screens are approved.

OPTION 3 — External web dashboard connected through Zoho APIs

Approach: build a React/Next.js frontend with secured server-side Zoho OAuth integration. Zoho CRM remains the system of record for leads, products, quotations and activities.

Advantages: maximum flexibility for a custom two- or three-button experience, user flows and branding. Limitations: custom authentication, authorization, token storage, API limits, edge-case handling, hosting, maintenance and security testing.

Fit: possible as a tightly scoped MVP, but not recommended as a full-featured external CRM within the same 10–12 day / base-cost commitment.

07 Options comparison

FACTOR	OPTION 1	OPTION 2	OPTION 3
Staff UI freedom	Moderate	High	Highest
Implementation effort	Lowest	Medium	Highest
Zoho dependency	Native CRM	CRM + Creator	CRM API
10–12 day fit	Best	Conditional	MVP only
Future maintenance	Lowest	Medium	Highest

Recommended approach: Option 1 for Phase 1. Present a simple three-action homepage for approval. Move to Option 2 or Option 3 only if ATPL requires complete replacement of day-to-day native Zoho screens.

08 Technical implementation approach

Existing Zoho–based solution (recommended)

- Review and preserve existing CRM data, user roles, fields, rules and integrations.
- Use CRM Leads and assignment workflows for the calling-to-sales handoff.
- Use Products and Quotes for catalogue-driven quotations; align the document output with the supplied Excel layout as technically feasible.
- Use filtered views and a home/dashboard screen for the 2–3 core tasks, executive activities and reporting.
- Apply least-privilege access so callers, sales executives and management see the appropriate records and actions.

External dashboard integration (if selected)

Frontend (Next.js / React) → protected application backend → server-managed OAuth/token and permission checks → Zoho CRM APIs → Leads, Products, Quotes, Activities and reports. Meta/Google lead capture can continue to feed Zoho; the custom portal reads and updates agreed records. CRM should remain the primary source of truth, with no duplicate lead database unless justified.

For external login, define employee accounts, access policies and audit history. Never place Zoho OAuth credentials or refresh tokens in client-side browser code. Confirm API entitlements, limits and quotation-generation capabilities before quoting a custom portal.

09 Delivery plan — 10 to 12 working days

DAYS	DELIVERABLE / MILESTONE
Day 1–2	Audit existing configuration, confirm subscription and roles; validate Excel template and product data; agree three-action screen mockup.
Day 3–4	CRM cleanup, simplified home/navigation and Fresh Leads/calling/assignment flow.
Day 5–7	Product catalogue, pricing logic, approved quotation template, executive and visit tracking.
Day 8–9	Meta/Google source mapping and integrations as needed; conversion/activity reports and manager dashboard.
Day 10	Complete workflow testing using sample and actual ATPL scenarios; client acceptance demonstration.
Day 11–12	Resolve agreed issues, finalize access and team training; documentation and handover.

Schedule assumptions: existing Zoho environment is accessible and usable; subscription supports the chosen features; existing lead sources can be connected without major reengineering; ATPL supplies product list, pricing, latest Excel format, user details and integration access promptly. Parallel work is expected. Substantial additional requirements require scope/timeline review.

10 Inputs required from ATPL

INPUT	REASON
Zoho edition / subscription and admin access	Confirm modules, Canvas/Creator availability, APIs, users and existing workflows.
Users, roles and licence count	Design caller, executive and manager permissions; confirm any added licences.
Product catalogue and approved prices	Import product data and enable quotation auto-pricing.
Latest Excel quotation/invoice format	Design and approve the quotation layout; identify required calculations and fields.
Meta and Google Ads/form access	Verify incoming lead types, integration status and source tracking.
Lead stage definitions and assignment rules	Confirm lifecycle, status names, reassignment and follow-up logic.
Meaning of site/work and visit activity	Choose appropriate fields, views and reports.
Definition of conversion and invoicing scope	Ensure meaningful reporting and decide whether GST final invoicing is in scope.

11 Deliverables and acceptance criteria

- Staff can find the three main actions quickly, with irrelevant navigation reduced for each role.
- New leads appear in Fresh Leads and can be called, updated and assigned without deleting their history.
- Assigned leads are visible to the correct sales executive, along with tasks and site visits.
- A user can choose an imported product and populate its configured price on a quotation.
- Quotation output follows the approved ATPL format, within agreed technical/template constraints.
- Managers can view source-wise leads, employee activity and conversions based on the approved definition.
- Agreed source integrations are tested with sample form submissions and failures are documented.
- User permissions are checked, key scenarios are accepted and operating guidance is delivered.

12 Scope controls and commercial note

Base scope: Zoho CRM-based UI simplification and agreed sales workflow modifications. Not included unless separately approved: repair-service CRM, full external CRM application, mobile apps, custom finance or accounting platform, unlimited UI revisions, complex historical data migration, or advanced GST invoice/accounting integration.

The earlier commercial proposal was ₹60,000. ATPL has indicated that the quotation should be reconsidered; a revised commercial offer is not finalized in this requirements plan. Options 2 and 3 require a separate estimate based on approved screens and system access.

Approval checkpoint: select Option 1, 2 or 3; approve functional scope, client inputs, pricing, and acceptance criteria before development begins.